Unit 10 World of Work

Top Topics

1. Volunteerism, Work and Employment
2. The Labour Force
3. Rights and Responsibilities of Employers and Employees
4. Industrial Relations

1 Volunteerism, Work and Employment

Volunteerism

Volunteerism is the practice of giving time, energy and expertise without payment, e.g. volunteering at your local GAA club to train junior children.

Benefits and rewards of volunteering

Individual	Organisation	Society
Sense of purpose: Volunteering gives individuals a sense of purpose and fulfilment by making a meaningful contribution to causes they care about and seeing the direct impact of their efforts. **Career opportunities:** Volunteering can enhance a CV by providing valuable work experience, and open doors to new career opportunities by showcasing skills and interests.	**Service provision:** Volunteers help the organisation to provide their services while keeping expenses such as wage bills low. **Extra expertise:** Volunteering allows employees to develop new skills, such as leadership, communication and teamwork, which can be transferred back to the workplace to enhance productivity.	**Social issues:** Volunteers play a crucial role in addressing pressing social issues such as poverty, homelessness, environmental conservation and education disparities. **Stronger communities:** Volunteer efforts help build stronger, more resilient communities by promoting collaboration, empathy and mutual support among residents.

Financial/monetary rewards: None

Work

Work is generally defined as a job that requires **effort**. You **don't necessarily receive payment** for work.

Rewards, benefits and challenges of work

Positive impacts/rewards	Negative impacts/challenges
• **Skills:** It offers the opportunity to develop skills and expertise, e.g. a Third Year Business student helping prepare a household budget at home. • **Satisfaction:** Putting effort into something can lead to satisfaction and benefits an individual's wellbeing.	• **Payment:** Typically, work does not involve payment, which can affect an individual's standard of living. • **Law:** Employment **law does not cover work** such as helping family and friends.

Financial/monetary rewards: None

Employment

Employment is **work** undertaken where a **payment** is received, e.g. teaching.

There are two main groups of people involved in employment:

- **Employer:** An entrepreneur or organisation that employs others.
- **Employee:** The name given to the individual who is working.

Rewards and benefits of employment

Individual	Organisation	Society
Payment/monetary: Employment allows an individual to earn an income, e.g. wage, salary, commission. They can spend this income on buying goods and services to satisfy needs and wants. **Personal satisfaction:** Individuals experience satisfaction, which may lead to personal development. It can also result in a promotion if you work hard.	**Profits:** Employees help the organisation provide their services and produce their goods, which increases profits. **Highly skilled workforce:** The business has a highly skilled and highly educated workforce, which can increase production and increase sales.	**Government revenue:** The government receives income from income taxes such as PAYE, PRSI and USC. They also receive revenue from tax on profits such as Self-Assessment Income Tax and corporation tax. **Social welfare:** The government reduces expenditure on social welfare, as with more people employed, social welfare payments decrease.

Financial/monetary rewards: Wages/salaries/profit sharing/benefit in kind (company car)/bonus/overtime

2 The Labour Force

The **labour force** is all the people who are **available to work**, and are **willing to work** at existing wage rates.

Types of Employment

Type of employment	Description
Self-employment	The entrepreneur **works for themselves**. They can pay themselves a wage or salary. They also get to keep any profit the business makes.
Full-time employment	Working **a standard number of hours per week**, usually 35 hours or more, in return for a monetary return/wage or salary. Typically comes with benefits such as paid time off and health insurance. Benefits in kind, e.g. company car.
Part-time employment	Working **fewer hours than a full-time employee**, usually less than 35 hours per week. Employees are paid for the hours worked and earn a wage or salary. Ideal for students balancing work with studies.
Temporary/casual employment	Short-term work arrangements, often to cover **seasonal** needs or specific projects. Can provide valuable experience but may not come with benefits.
Freelance employment	Working as an **independent contractor**, often on a project basis. Offers flexibility in choosing projects and working hours, e.g. a journalist.

These types of employment can take place in the public sector or the private sector.

~~**Public sector**~~	**Private sector**
The Irish government runs businesses that are known as **state-sponsored bodies**, or they have a share in a business known as a **semi-state body**. These businesses are started and funded by the government, and the government employs managers to run the businesses. The **government is an employer**, e.g. teachers, doctors, civil servants.	The private sector is the section of the economy where **individuals set up their own businesses**. Examples include sole traders, partnerships, private limited companies and public limited companies. Multinational companies (MNCs)/transnational companies (TNCs).

Sectors of the Economy Explain them

Different types of employment can be further classified into industries. These industries are called sectors of the economy.

- The **primary sector** is also known as the **extractive** industry. It is where raw materials, such as oil, are taken from the earth.
- The **secondary sector** includes **manufacturing and construction**. This is turning raw materials into finished products.
- The **tertiary sector** is also known as the **service** industry. This is the selling of finished goods and the provision of services.

Unemployment

The **unemployment rate** is an economic indicator that measures the percentage of the labour force that is **actively seeking employment but is currently unable to find work**. These people receive a payment from the government known as the **Jobseeker's Allowance**.

Reasons for unemployment

- Recession
- Technology

Impacts of unemployment

- Household budget
- Economic implications
- Financial/monetary rewards: Jobseeker's allowance

3 Rights and Responsibilities of Employers and Employees

When employing staff, the entrepreneur should:

1. Decide on number of employees needed
2. Draft a **job description**
3. **Advertise**
4. Collect **Curriculum Vitae** (CVs), application forms and references
5. **Shortlist** the most suitable applicants
6. Hold **interviews**
7. Offer the job to the best **candidate**

Employees will have a **probationary period**.

Both the employee and the employer will sign a **contract of employment**.

Training will be provided for the new employees. This is known as induction.

Know 2 rights and 2 responsibilities

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Legal perspective	• **Employer rights:** Knowing the laws and rules they must follow when employing someone, e.g. contracts of employment, minimum wage laws and discrimination and trade union recognition. • **Employee rights:** Understanding what they are entitled to at work, like fair pay, a safe working environment, not to be treated less favourably than others, and allowed to join a trade union.
Social perspective	• **Employer responsibilities:** Making sure everyone feels welcome and safe at work. Promoting diversity and supporting employee wellbeing. • **Employee responsibilities:** Being a good team member and following the company's rules. Collaborating with other workers and treating everyone fairly.
Environmental perspective	• **Employer responsibilities:** Doing things that are good for the environment at work. Implementing sustainable goals and complying with environmental regulations. • **Employee responsibilities:** Helping to save energy and resources while working and following the organisation's environmental initiatives.
Ethical perspective	• **Employer responsibilities:** Being fair and honest in business decisions. • **Employee responsibilities:** Acting with honesty and integrity in their work.

There are **many laws** that protect employees. These are set by both the **Irish government** and the **European Union (EU)**.

- Protection of Young Persons (Employment) Act, 1996
- Employment Equality Act, 1998–2015
- Unfair Dismissals Act, 1977–2015
- Health and Safety Act, 2005
- National Minimum Wage Act, 2000

A **minimum wage** is the least amount an employee can be paid per hour for work done. Ireland has a legal minimum wage set by the government in the National Budget.

Employee rights; get paid, get holidays

Employee responsibilities; do their job, punctual

Employer rights; hire suitable staff, fire staff when justified

Employer responsibilities; pay fair wage, maintain safe and healthy working conditions

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4 Industrial Relations

Industrial relations refer to the relationship between **employers and employees** in the **workplace.**

The positive impacts of a good relationship between the employer and the employee:

Employer/business	Employee
Increased motivation: Happy staff work harder and produce more. This increases the sales and profits of the business. **Low staff turnover:** There will be a low turnover of staff, as employees will have loyalty to the organisation and enjoy their work. This will decrease training costs for the business.	**Nice working atmosphere:** With no industrial disputes, staff will be happy and enjoy working. They will not look to move to another place of employment. **Levels of self-esteem and wellbeing:** Happy staff will feel more motivated and confident in themselves.

If there are **poor industrial relations**, this will result in the **opposite impact**, e.g. absenteeism, strikes, high staff turnover and a decrease in profits.

Trade Unions

Trade unions are **organisations of workers** in a trade, or group of trades or professions, formed to **represent and protect the rights and interests of employees.**

Examples of trade unions: Association of Secondary Teachers in Ireland (ASTI), Teachers' Union of Ireland (TUI), Fórsa, Mandate, Services, Industrial, Professional and Teachers' Union (SIPTU)

Role/function of a trade union

- Protect employees
- Negotiate
- Represent

Shop stewards

A **shop steward** is an individual who is **elected by members** and who **represents** the trade union in the workplace.

Role/function of a shop steward:

- **Collect** union fees
- **Recruit** new members
- **Represent** members when meeting with management
- Provide union information/**updates** to staff

Reasons for Disputes

- Wages and benefits
- Working conditions
- Job security
- Discrimination and harassment
- Trade union recognition
- Health and safety concerns

Industrial Actions

Industrial action is a way for employees to demonstrate their dissatisfaction and to put pressure on employers to meet their demands.

Types of industrial action

- ~~Official strikes~~
- Work stoppages
- Go-slows/work-to-rule
- Boycotts

Solving Disputes

There are many ways of solving a dispute in the workplace such as talking it through or strike action.

There are two government sponsored bodies that can help to solve the dispute.

Workplace Relations Commission (WRC)

- Promotes **good industrial relations**
- Encourages employers and employees **to follow laws**
- Sets up negotiations to **solve disputes** between employers and employees
- **Conciliation** is a service provided by WRC. A mediator listens to both sides and makes suggestions to solve the disputes
- Conducts **research** and provide advice
- **Advises** the government on implementing new laws

Labour Court

- Known as the **court of last resort**
- Deals with **unsolved disputes** by the WRC
- They listen to both sides and come up with a solution known as **arbitration**
- The employer has 42 days to act on the Labour Court decision. If they don't act, the next step is the District Court

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Unit 12 Organisations' Positive and Negative Impacts on Communities

Topic Topics

1. Economic Impacts Money
2. Social Impacts People
3. Environmental Impacts The world we live in

1 Economic Impacts

The **economic** perspective looks at the impacts of an organisation from a **monetary point** of view, i.e. the flow of money in and out of a community.

Positive impacts	Negative impacts
Creates employment: An organisation hires local workers. **Increases the standard of living:** Employees can spend their income on satisfying their needs and wants, which leads to a better standard of living. **Creates spin-off effects:** Employees tend to spend most of their income in their local areas.	**Creates footloose businesses:** Organisations that are footloose have no loyalty to the areas and may close at any time. **Creates competition:** Multinational companies operating in Ireland are in competition with local or domestic businesses. The local businesses may be forced to close. **Increases demand for houses:** This can cause a shortage of housing. Property and rental prices may increase, placing a financial burden on the local community.

2 Social Impacts

The **social** perspective looks at how the activities of an organisation can affect those living in the community.

Positive impacts	Negative impacts
Encourages job satisfaction: Employees experience job satisfaction and security. **Improves facilities:** When a business opens up, it attracts more businesses/people to that area. **Creates sponsorship:** Businesses can sponsor events and local clubs, which is a superb boost for the community.	**Puts pressure on local facilities:** Often the infrastructure is not good enough and local government finances can be stretched. If the community expands, it may lose that local town effect. **Encourages anti-social behaviour:** The influx of more people in a community and lack of services can lead to anti-social behaviour. **Alters industrial relations:** If employers don't treat employees well or act in an unethical way, it may result in the employees quitting their jobs or engaging in industrial action.

3 Environmental Impacts

The **environmental** perspective sees things as they relate to a community's air, water, land, wildlife, etc.

Positive impacts	Negative impacts
Organisations may adopt green policies like the following: • Encouraging **biodegradable** products • Using **green energy**, e.g. wind, solar • Encouraging employees to use **public transport**/car-pooling/walk/cycle to work	**Contaminates facilities:** Some organisations can contaminate local facilities, e.g. water supplies. **Increases pollution:** Increased traffic congestion may lead to air pollution. Increased production can lead to increased emissions, which can be harmful to the environment. **Resource depletion:** Extraction industries such as oil can deplete natural resources, leading to long-term environmental impacts.

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)

When businesses/organisations practise corporate social responsibility (CSR), they combine their social and environmental responsibilities with their normal business operations.

Some key responsibilities under CSR are:

- **Environmental:** Reducing carbon footprints, managing waste and conserving resources.
- **Social:** Supporting communities' development, promoting diversity and inclusion, and ensuring employee wellbeing and fair treatment.
- **Economic:** Using ethical business practices, being honest with investors, and contributing to economic growth.

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Unit 13 Impact of Technologies on an Organisation

Top Topics

1. Digital Technology
2. Rewards and Costs of Digital Technology

1 Digital Technology

Digital technology refers to the use of electronic devices and systems that work with digital information.

Digital technology has revolutionised the way businesses operate and interact with customers.

Some technology tools are:

- Video conferencing/voice call
- Websites
- Emailing
- Text messaging
- Excel and Google Sheets
- Social media
- Online banking
- Instant messaging
- eLearning
- Apps

Types of Digital Technology for Businesses/Organisations

Communications
- Emailing
- Video conferencing/voice call
- Text messaging
- Desktop publishing apps
- Presentations
- Broadband
- Wi-Fi

Financial
- Excel and Google Sheets
- Online banking
- Payroll software
- Sending business documents
- Graphs and charts

Transportation
- Tracking of vehicles
- Refrigerated and temperature-controlled vehicles

Social media
- Websites
- Web analytics
- Apps

Production
- CAD (computer-aided design)
- CAM (computer-aided manufacturing)
- CIM (computer-integrated manufacturing

Marketing and sales
- Websites
- Databases
- Electronic point of sale (EPOS)
- Market research

Data storage
- Cloud computing
- Data storage in the cloud

2 Rewards and Costs of Digital Technology

Rewards	Costs
Increased efficiency: Digital technologies automate processes, streamline workflows and reduce manual tasks, leading to improved operational efficiency and productivity. **Enhanced communication:** Digital tools like email, messaging apps and video conferencing facilitate seamless communication within the organisation and with customers, suppliers and partners. **Cost savings:** By automating processes, reducing paperwork and optimising resources, digital technologies can lead to cost savings in areas such as operations, marketing and customer service.	**Cybersecurity risks:** Businesses are vulnerable to cyber threats such as data breaches, malware attacks, phishing scams and ransomware, which can compromise sensitive information and damage reputation. **Cost of implementation:** Investing in digital technologies, infrastructure upgrades, software licenses and cybersecurity measures can be costly for businesses, especially for small and medium-sized enterprises. **Legal compliance:** Businesses must navigate complex legal frameworks related to data protection, cybersecurity, intellectual property rights and online transactions when using digital technologies.

Cost reductions

You can reduce the cost of technology by:

- Reducing number of employees = reduction in wages/labour
- Encouraging employees to work from home so you don't need premises
- Understanding that communication is instant and cheaper via technology
- Decreasing your marketing and advertising costs

General Data Protection Regulation GDPR

GDPR stands for **General Data Protection Regulation**. It is a set of rules designed to **protect** the personal data of **individuals** within the European Union (EU).

Functions of GDPR are:

- Data protection
- Consent
- Data rights
- Security measures
- Penalties